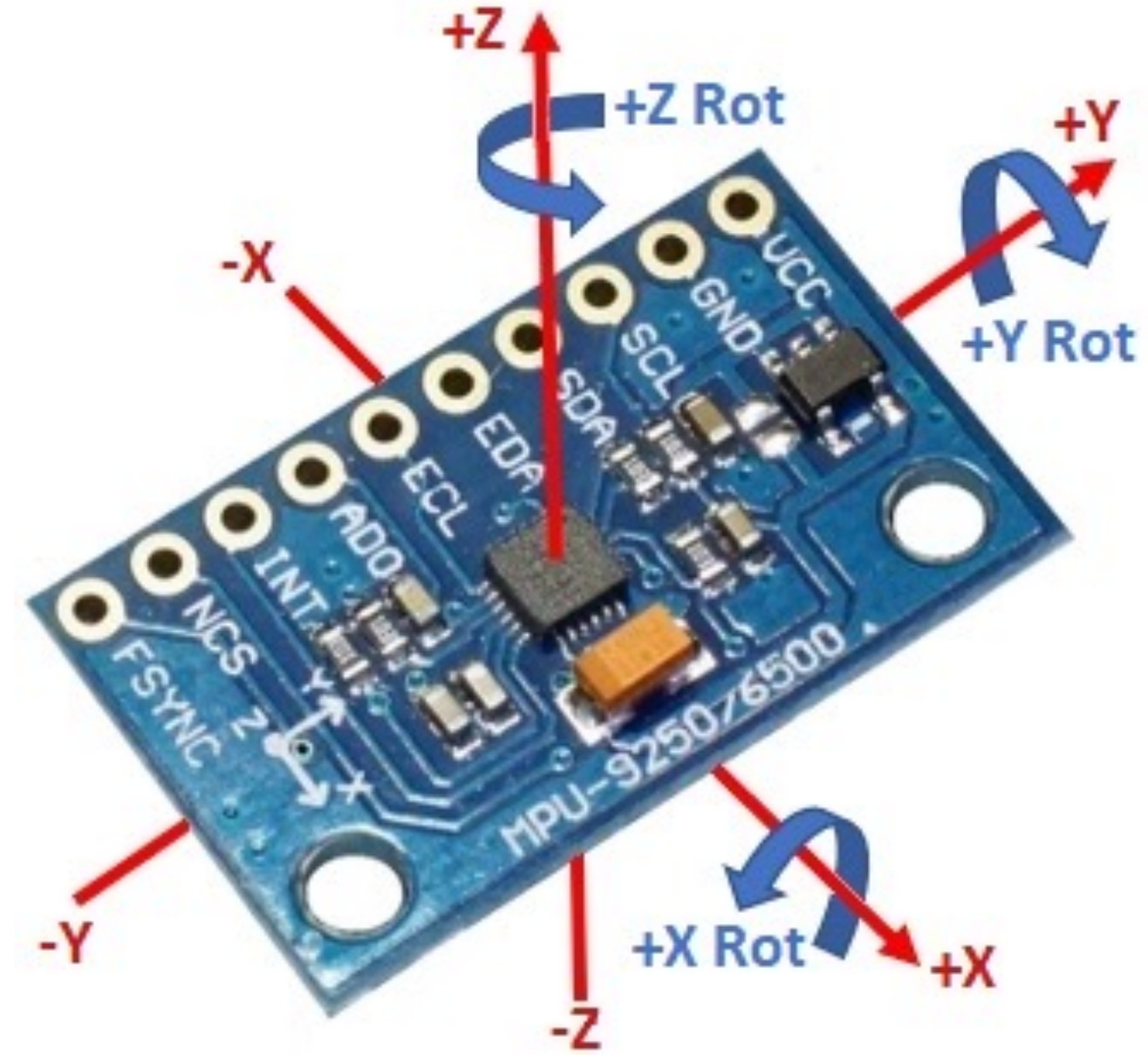


I²C and IMU

Huaishu Peng | UMD CS | Fall 2026



3-axis accelerometer + 3-axis gyroscope
Measures motion, orientation, and angular velocity

Accelerometer

Range: $\pm 2g$, $\pm 4g$, $\pm 8g$, $\pm 16g$

Gyroscope

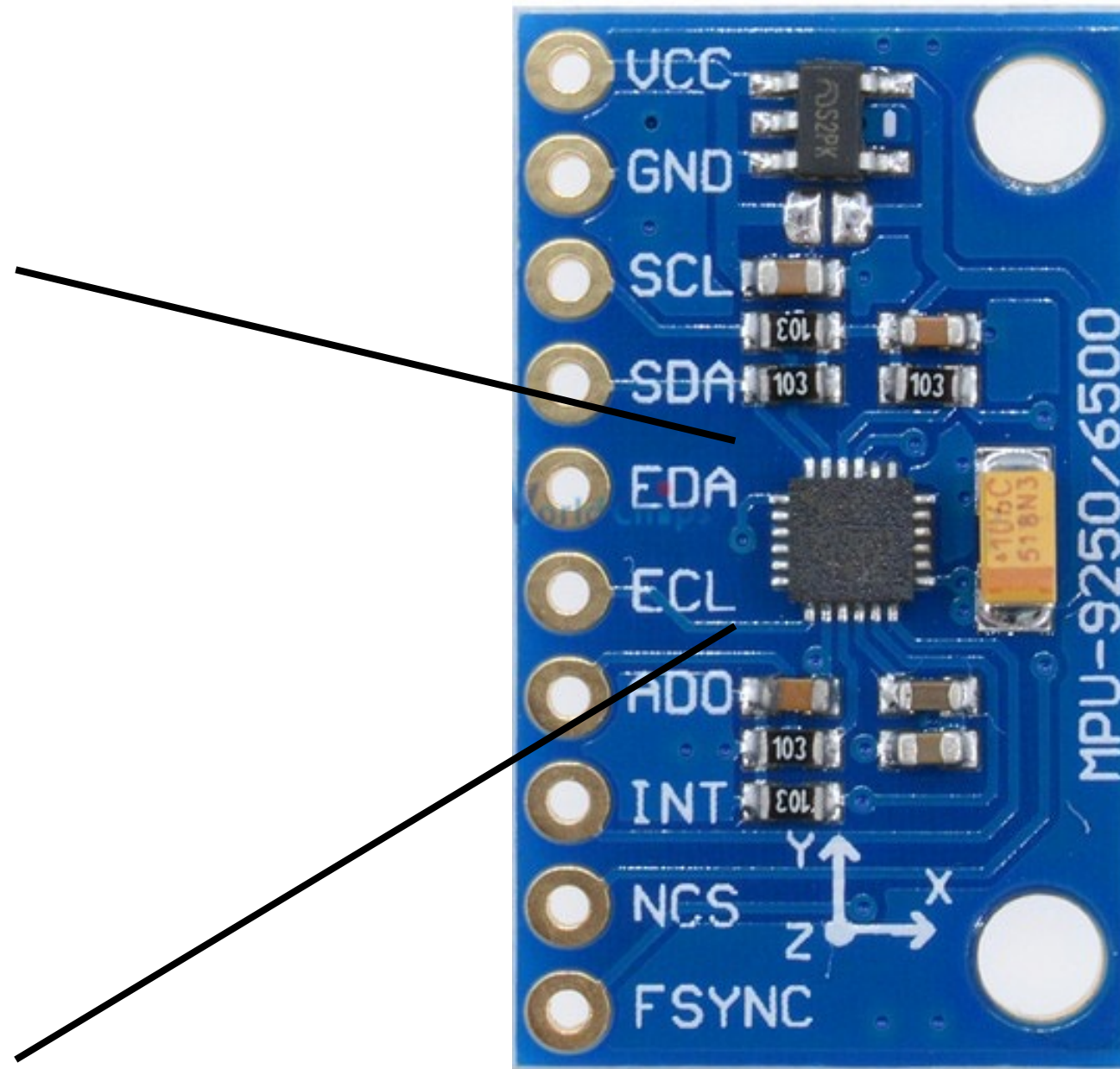
Range: ± 250 , ± 500 , ± 1000 , ± 2000 °/s

SPI + I²C



Invensense MPU-6500

<https://datasheet.octopart.com/MPU-6500-InvenSense-datasheet-138896167.pdf>



3.3V _____

GND _____

? _____



I²C

I2C stands for Inter-Integrated Circuit

is a serial protocol for two-wire interface to connect devices like microcontrollers and other similar peripherals in embedded systems

It is used by almost all major IC manufacturers

I2C bus is popular because it is simple to use (only need **2** signal lines)

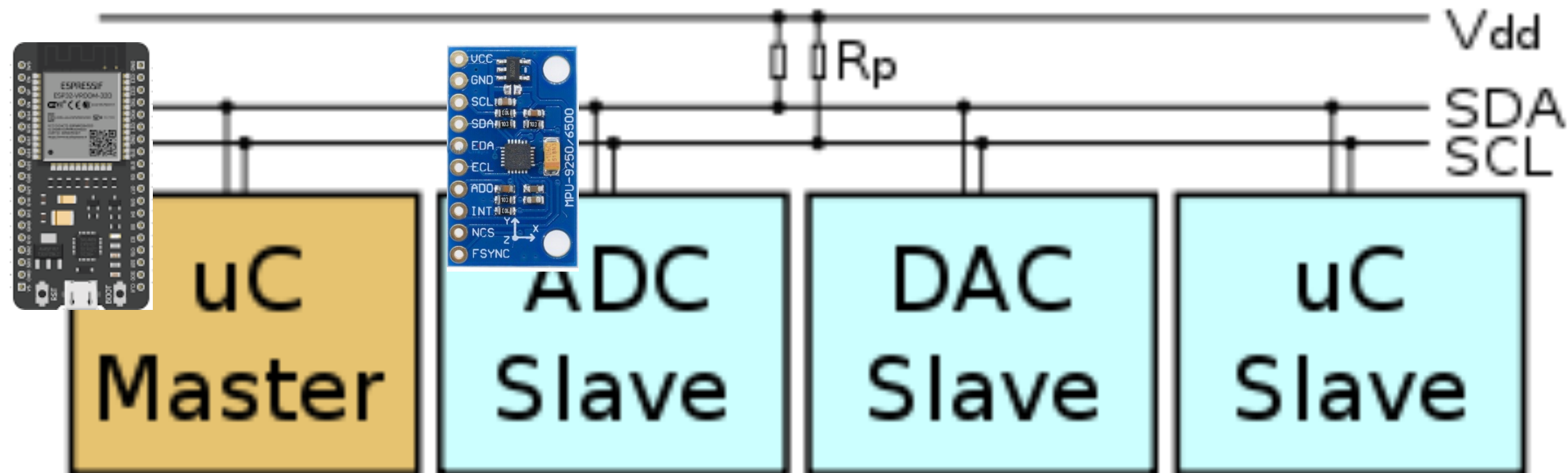
I²C

4 wires in total

VCC and GND

SDA (serial data) and SCL (serial clock)

Primary-standby (Master-Slave) architecture (bi-directional)



I²C

How does the ESP32 know which peripheral devices to talk/listen to?

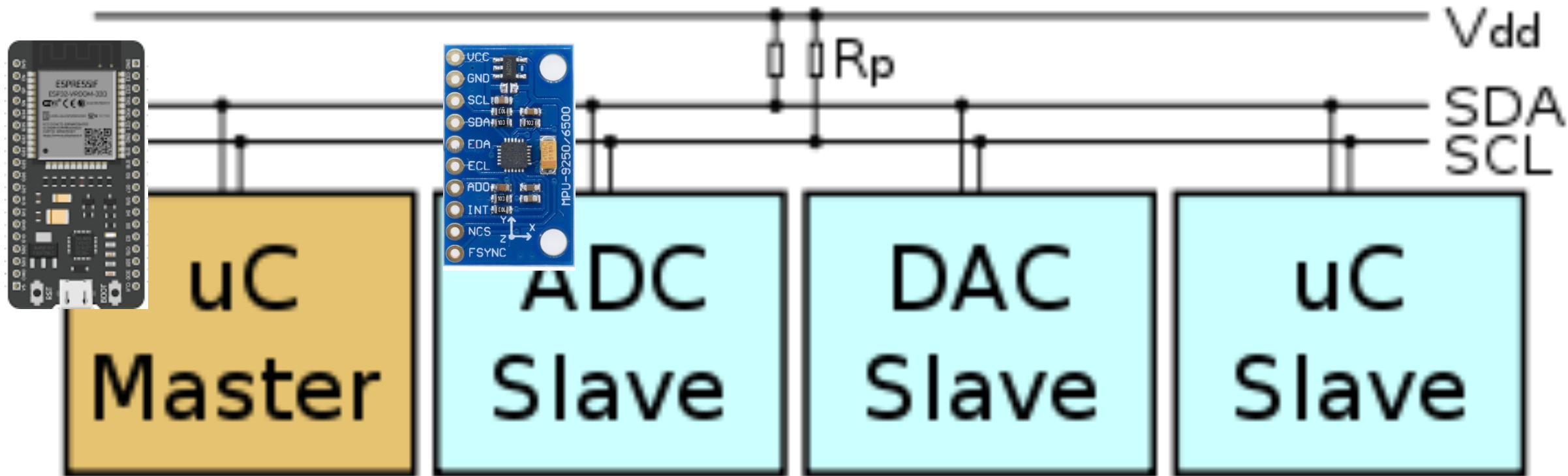
Each of the peripheral device has a 7-bit **address** in the datasheet – it’s the “**name**” of the device

The address is written in the datasheet

Typical Operating Circuit of section 4.2, VDD = 1.8V, VDDIO = 1.8V, T_A=25°C, unless otherwise noted.

Parameter	Conditions	MIN	TYP	MAX	Units	NOTES
SUPPLIES						
Supply Ramp Time	Monotonic ramp. Ramp rate is 10% to 90% of the final value	0.1		100	ms	1
TEMPERATURE SENSOR						
Operating Range	Ambient	-40		85	°C	1
Sensitivity	Untrimmed		333.87		LSB/°C	
Room Temp Offset	21°C		0		LSB	
Power-On RESET						
Supply Ramp Time (T _{RAMP})	Valid power-on RESET	0.01	20	100	ms	1
Start-up time for register read/write	From power-up		11	100	ms	1
I ² C ADDRESS	AD0 = 0 AD0 = 1		1101000 1101001			

<https://datasheet.octopart.com/MPU-6500-InvenSense-datasheet-138896167.pdf>

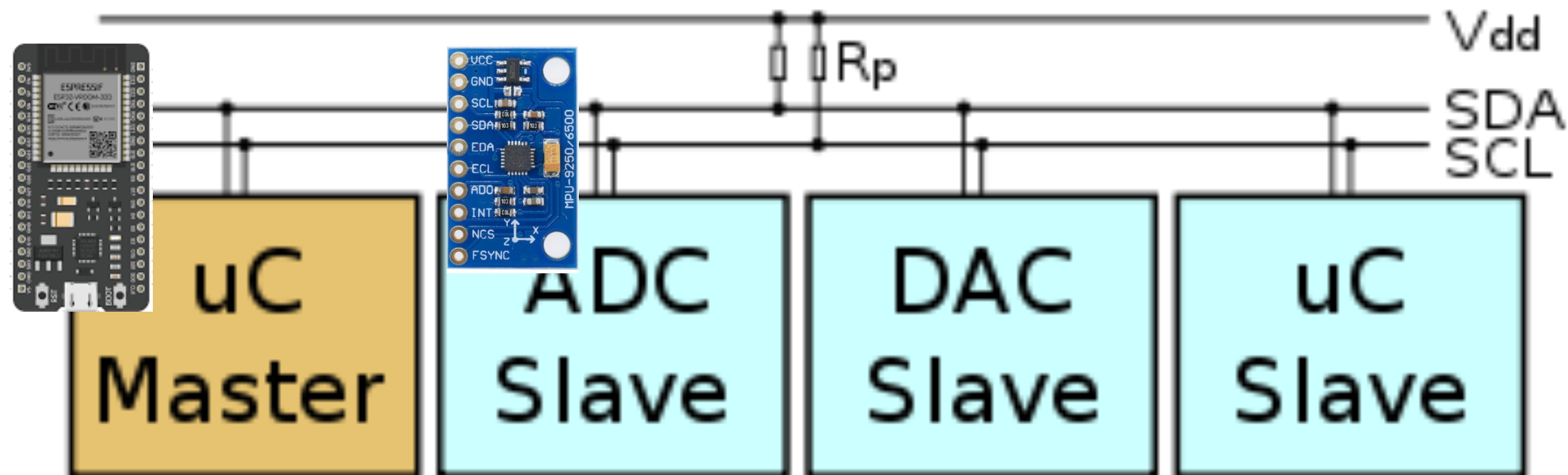
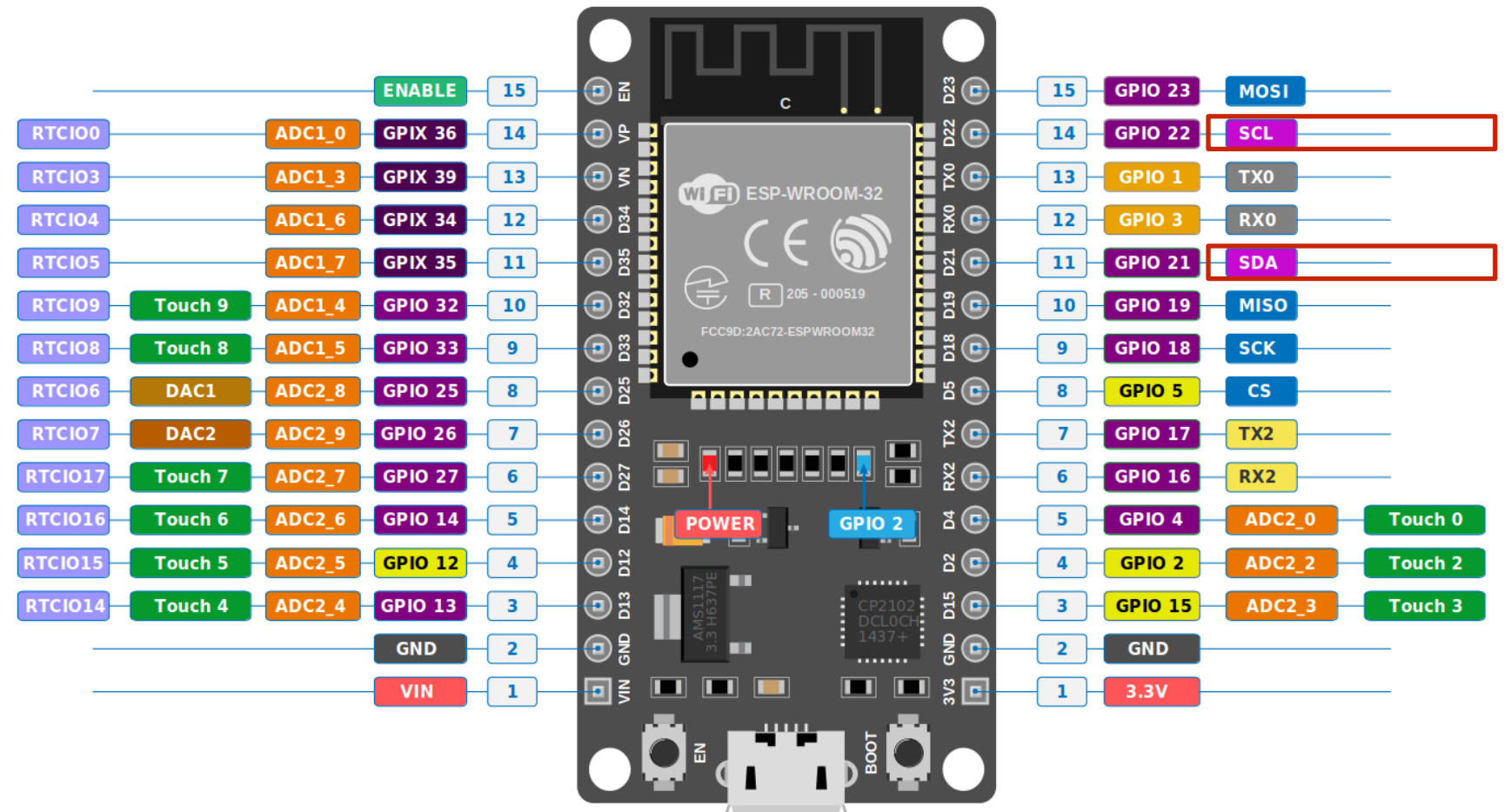


I²C

How does the ESP32 know which peripheral devices to talk/listen to?

Can we use any pins on Arduino to connect to SDA and SCL?

GPIO 21 -> SDA; GPIO 22-> SCL



I²C

4 wires in total signal lines

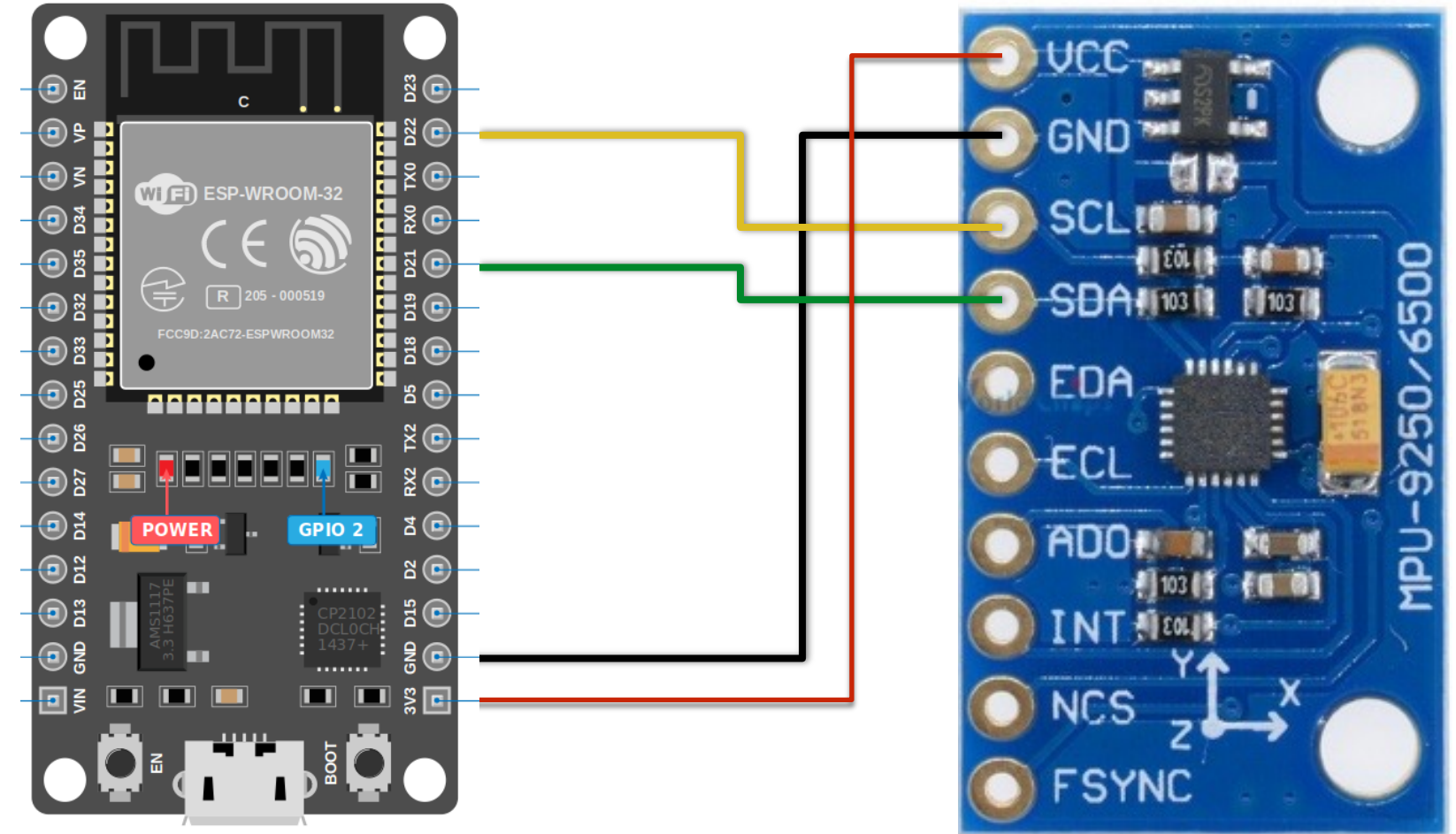
VCC and GND

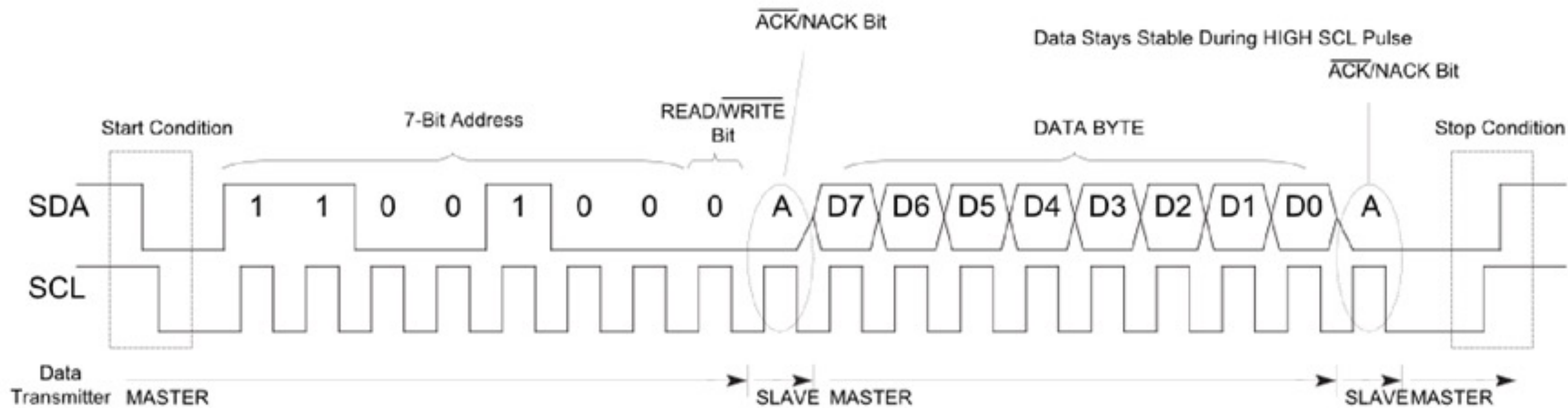
SDA (serial data) and SCL (serial clock)

GPIO 21 -> SDA; GPIO 22-> SCL

Address:
0b1101000
(0x68)

SDA
SCL





How to read data from the IC?

I²C library in Arduino - Wire library

Setup

Reading a register

Updating a register

I²C library in Arduino - Wire library

```
#include <Wire.h>
```

Setup

Reading a register

What are register(s)?

- consider it as a **specific multi-functional storage space** of an IC

Updating a register

- We can **read** sensor data from certain register(s)
- We can also **write** a **specific data to one register** to change the sensor's behavior

I²C library in Arduino - Wire library

Setup

Updating a register

Reading a register

```
#include <Arduino.h>
#include <Wire.h>

const int sda = 21;
const int scl = 22;

void setup() {
    Wire.begin(sda, scl);
    Serial.begin(9600);
}
```

I²C library in Arduino - Wire library

Setup

Reading a register

Updating a register

I²C library in Arduino - Wire library

Setup

Let's try to read the accelerometer data along X axis from our sensor

Reading a register

First, send a read request

- **Wire.beginTransmission(addr)** opens communication with device addr -> **0x68**
- **Wire.write(value)** register that you are looking for
- **Wire.endTransmission()** sends the request and returns

Updating a register

Then, read the answer to the request

- **Wire.requestFrom(addr, length)** prepares to read *length* bytes from addr
- **Wire.read()** reads the next available byte

endTransmission()

Description

This function ends a transmission to a peripheral device that was begun by `beginTransmission()` and transmits the bytes that were queued by `write()`. As of Arduino 1.0.1, `endTransmission()` accepts a

I²C library in Arduino - Wire library

Setup

<https://www.waveshare.com/w/upload/0/03/MPU6050-Register-Map-and-Descriptions.pdf>

Reading a register

First, send a read request

- **Wire.beginTransmission(addr)** opens communication with device addr -> **0x68**
- **Wire.write(value)** register that you are looking for
- **Wire.endTransmission()** sends the request and returns

Updating a register

Then, read the answer to the request

- **Wire.requestFrom(addr, length)** prepares to read *length* bytes from addr
- **Wire.read()** reads the next available byte

Addr (Hex)	Addr (Dec.)	Register Name	Serial I/F	Bit7	Bit6	Bit5	Bit4	Bit3	Bit2	Bit1	Bit0
3B	59	ACCEL_XOUT_H	R	ACCEL_XOUT_H[15:8]							
3C	60	ACCEL_XOUT_L	R	ACCEL_XOUT_L[7:0]							
3D	61	ACCEL_YOUT_H	R	ACCEL_YOUT_H[15:8]							
3E	62	ACCEL_YOUT_L	R	ACCEL_YOUT_L[7:0]							
3F	63	ACCEL_ZOUT_H	R	ACCEL_ZOUT_H[15:8]							
40	64	ACCEL_ZOUT_L	R	ACCEL_ZOUT_L[7:0]							

I²C library in Arduino - Wire library

Setup

Reading a register

Updating a register

**Address: 0b1101000
(0x68)**



We first need to read the left 8 bit of accel_x from register 3B

First, send a read request

- `Wire.beginTransmission(0x68)`; opens communication with the sensor using its address
- `Wire.write(0x3B)`; tell the sensor which register we are requesting
- `Wire.endTransmission()`; sends the request and returns

Then, read the answer to the request

- Wire.requestFrom(**0x68**, **1**); prepares to read *length* byte from the sensor address
- acc_x **h** = Wire.read() reads the available byte

Addr (Hex)	Addr (Dec.)	Register Name	Serial I/F	Bit7	Bit6	Bit5	Bit4	Bit3	Bit2	Bit1	Bit0
3B	59	ACCEL_XOUT_H	R	ACCEL_XOUT_H[15:8]							
3C	60	ACCEL_XOUT_L	R	ACCEL_XOUT_L[7:0]							
3D	61	ACCEL_YOUT_H	R	ACCEL_YOUT_H[15:8]							
3E	62	ACCEL_YOUT_L	R	ACCEL_YOUT_L[7:0]							
3F	63	ACCEL_ZOUT_H	R	ACCEL_ZOUT_H[15:8]							
40	64	ACCEL_ZOUT_L	R	ACCEL_ZOUT_L[7:0]							

I²C library in Arduino - Wire library

Setup

Reading a register

Updating a register

**Address: 0b1101000
(0x68)**



To get the entire 16bit of the ACC_X data, we need the ACC_L as well

First, send a read request

- `Wire.beginTransmission(0x68)`; opens communication with the sensor using its address
- `Wire.write(0x3C)`; tell the sensor which register we are requesting
- `Wire.endTransmission()`; sends the request and returns

Then, read the answer to the request

- Wire.requestFrom(**0x68**, **1**); prepares to read *length* byte from the sensor address
- acc_x |= Wire.read() reads the available byte

Addr (Hex)	Addr (Dec.)	Register Name	Serial I/F	Bit7	Bit6	Bit5	Bit4	Bit3	Bit2	Bit1	Bit0
3B	59	ACCEL_XOUT_H	R	ACCEL_XOUT_H[15:8]							
3C	60	ACCEL_XOUT_L	R	ACCEL_XOUT_L[7:0]							
3D	61	ACCEL_YOUT_H	R	ACCEL_YOUT_H[15:8]							
3E	62	ACCEL_YOUT_L	R	ACCEL_YOUT_L[7:0]							
3F	63	ACCEL_ZOUT_H	R	ACCEL_ZOUT_H[15:8]							
40	64	ACCEL_ZOUT_L	R	ACCEL_ZOUT_L[7:0]							

I²C library in Arduino - Wire library

Setup

Next, we need to combine the data from 3B and 3C

Reading a register

```
acc_x_combined = acc_x_h << 8 | acc_x_l;
```

Updating a register

Address: 0b1101000
(0x68)



bitwise SHIFT and OR operation

A = 0b11110101

B = 0b01010101

A << 8

0b11110101 00000000

A << 8 | B

0b11110101 01010101

I²C library in Arduino - Wire library

Setup

Reading a register

Updating a register

Address: 0b1101000
(0x68)



Last step, make the data mean something to us

Each 16-bit accelerometer measurement has a full scale defined in *ACCEL_FS* (Register 28). For each full scale setting, the accelerometers' **sensitivity** per LSB in *ACCEL_xOUT* is shown in the table below.

AFS_SEL	Full Scale Range	LSB Sensitivity
0	±2g	16384 LSB/g
1	±4g	8192 LSB/g
2	±8g	4096 LSB/g
3	±16g	2048 LSB/g

The result is raw data

Divided raw data by 16384.0 to get meaningful data
 $gX = acc_x_combined / 16384.0;$

I²C library in Arduino - Wire library

Setup

Reading a register

Updating a register

Address: 0b1101000
(0x68)



```
void loop() {  
  Wire.beginTransmission(address);  
  Wire.write(0x3B);  
  Wire.endTransmission();  
  
  Wire.requestFrom(address, 1);  
  ACCEL_XOUT_H = Wire.read();  
  
  Wire.beginTransmission(address);  
  Wire.write(0x3C);  
  Wire.endTransmission();  
  
  Wire.requestFrom(address, 1);  
  ACCEL_XOUT_L = Wire.read();  
  
  ACCEL_X_RAW = ACCEL_XOUT_H << 8 | ACCEL_XOUT_L;  
  
  gX = ACCEL_X_RAW / 16384.0;  
  
  //Plot data  
  Serial.print(">gX:");  
  Serial.println(gX);  
  delay(10);  
}
```

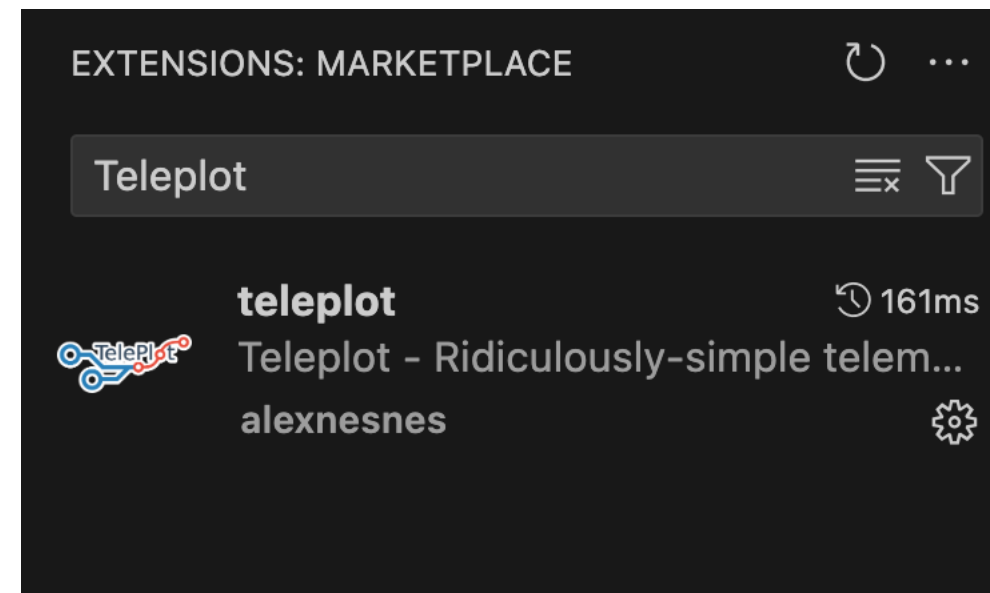
I²C library in Arduino - Wire library

Setup

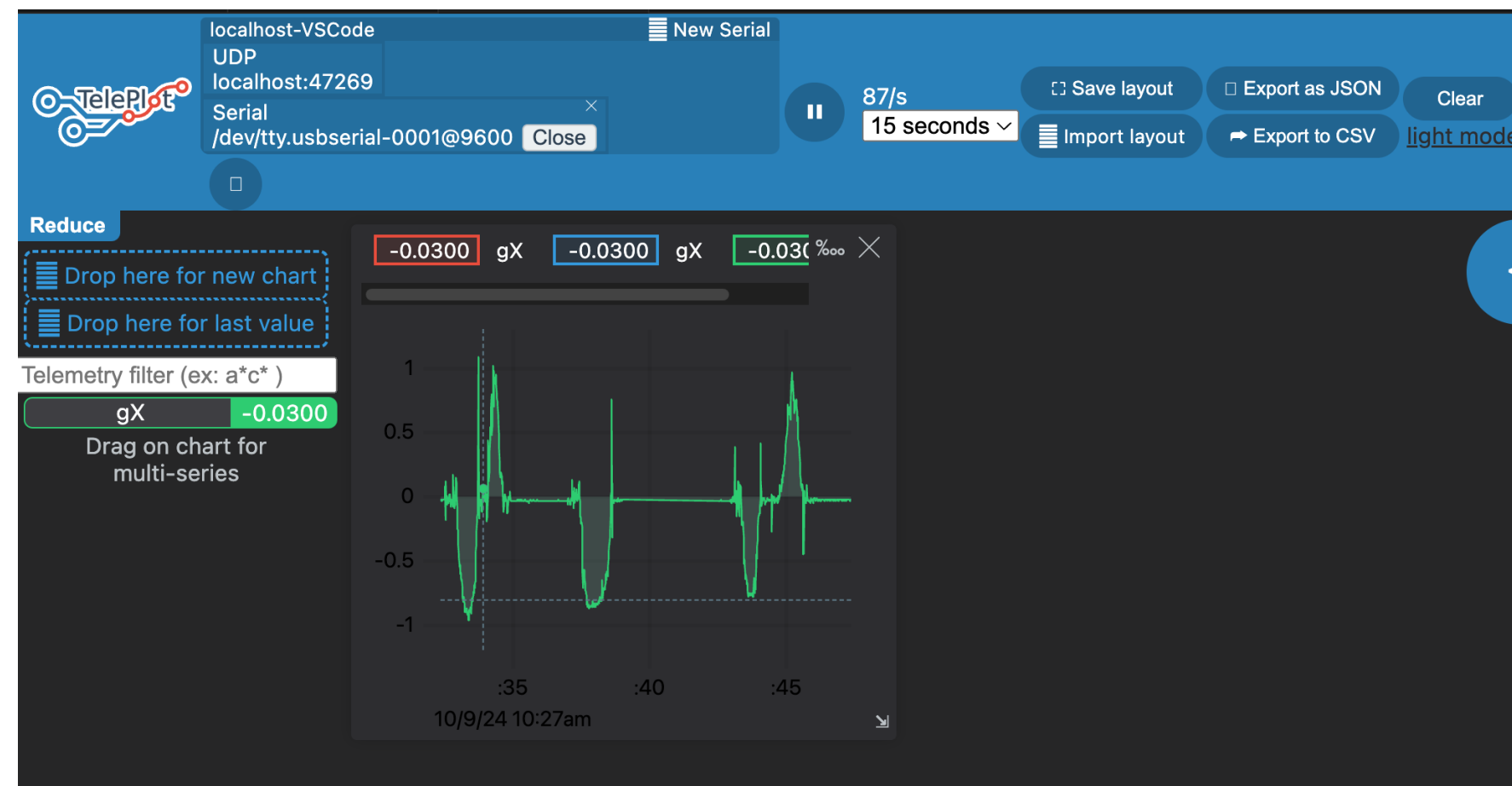
Reading a register

Updating a register

Address: 0b1101000
(0x68)



Install Teleplot plugin to visualize the reading



Things you can try:

1. Read all XYZ Accelerometer Data and print them out in a meaningful way
2. Read all XYZ Gyro Data, print the raw value.
3. Move the IMU along each axis with acceleration, observe how the data looks like. You can use Teleplot for observation.
4. Send us a video link of the experiment.

Register Map: <https://smartlab.cs.umd.edu/CMSC730/assets/file/MPU6050-Register-Map-and-Descriptions.pdf>

Datasheet: <https://smartlab.cs.umd.edu/CMSC730/assets/file/InvenSense-MPU-6500-datasheet.pdf>